



» T20 WORLD CUP BUMPER ANALYSIS

Turning point: A year after India's historic title win in the inaugural T20 World Cup in 2007, the Indian Premier League (IPL) was formally launched, irrevocably transforming the sport's landscape. PICS: GETTY IMAGES

From reluctance to reinvention

How India shed its T20 inhibitions to become the format's **defining force.**

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Though India has been averse to change historically, it has also epitomised the ability to see revolutions to their logical end once it sheds the inhibitions of the past. The Indian T20 cricket experience and the twin World Cup triumphs in the format encapsulate both the initial reluctance and the eventual efflorescence. The Indians may have been latecomers to the T20 party, but they are well and truly the life and soul of it.

MS Dhoni and his brigade of youngsters

almost gatecrashed the inaugural World T20 in 2007. The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), sceptical of this abridged version of the game, reluctantly sent a team for the tournament after being outvoted 10-1 in an ICC meeting convened to decide the fate of the World T20.

Still, the 20-over game was perceived as a recreational novelty rather than a serious sport, and Dhoni embarked for South Africa with a motley bunch sans stalwarts Sachin Tendulkar, Rahul Dravid and Sourav Ganguly, who were still smarting from a humiliating ODI World Cup campaign in the Caribbean that had ended a few months earlier.